RECIPE: TRADITIONAL ZIMBABWEAN ZVINYENZE

Servings: 4 | **Prep time:** 15 mins | **Cook time:** 2.5–3 hours

Description

Zvinyenze (braided goat or ox intestines) is a prized Zimbabwean delicacy. This recipe simplifies the traditional slow-cooking process to ensure the offal is tender and coated in a rich, savory tomato gravy.

Ingredients

- **1 kg** Zvinyenze (cleaned and braided intestines/tripe)
- **2 tbsp** Cooking oil
- **1 large** Onion, finely diced
- **3 large** Tomatoes, grated
- **2 cloves** Garlic, minced
- **1 tsp** Curry powder
- **½ tsp** Turmeric
- **Salt and black pepper** to taste
- **Boiling water** (as needed)

Instructions

1. Searing the Meat

- Thoroughly rinse the pre-braided zvinyenze.
- Heat oil in a heavy-bottomed pot over medium-high heat.
- Add the zvinyenze and brown for 5 minutes, stirring occasionally.

2. Tenderizing (The Long Simmer)

- Pour in enough boiling water to fully cover the meat.
- Reduce heat to **low** and cover the pot with a tight-fitting lid.
- Simmer for **2 to 3 hours**. Add small amounts of boiling water if the pot dries out before the meat is tender.

3. Sautéing Aromatics

- Once the meat is tender and the water has reduced to a small amount of oily residue, add the onions and garlic.
- Sauté for 3–5 minutes until the onions are soft.

4. Finishing the Gravy

- Stir in the curry powder, turmeric, and grated tomatoes.
- Season with salt and pepper.
- Cover and simmer for another 15 minutes until the tomatoes form a thick, rich sauce.

Serving Suggestion

Serve hot alongside a mound of **Sadza** and **Muriwo** (steamed greens like Covo or Rape).

Chef's Note

- **Texture:** Do not rush the simmering process. Zvinyenze should be soft to the bite, not rubbery.
- **Thickness:** If you prefer a thicker gravy, mix 1 tsp of soup powder (Usavi Mix) with a little water and stir it in during the final 5 minutes of cooking.